Brand Identity Sampler

Work by Pablo Defendini

Prepared for Edward Betancourt 26 January 2023

BRAND IDENTITY SAMPLER

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Abigarden

Abigarden: An app for managing a residential condominium

Prepared for Edward Betancourt 26 January 2023

BRAND IDENTITY SAMPLER

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Natalie Distefano Studio: A hair and makeup service for film and TV production

Prepared for Edward Betancourt 26 January 2023

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Safari Books Online: An ebook subscription service

Prepared for Edward Betancourt 26 January 2023

Safari Rebrand and Product Growth

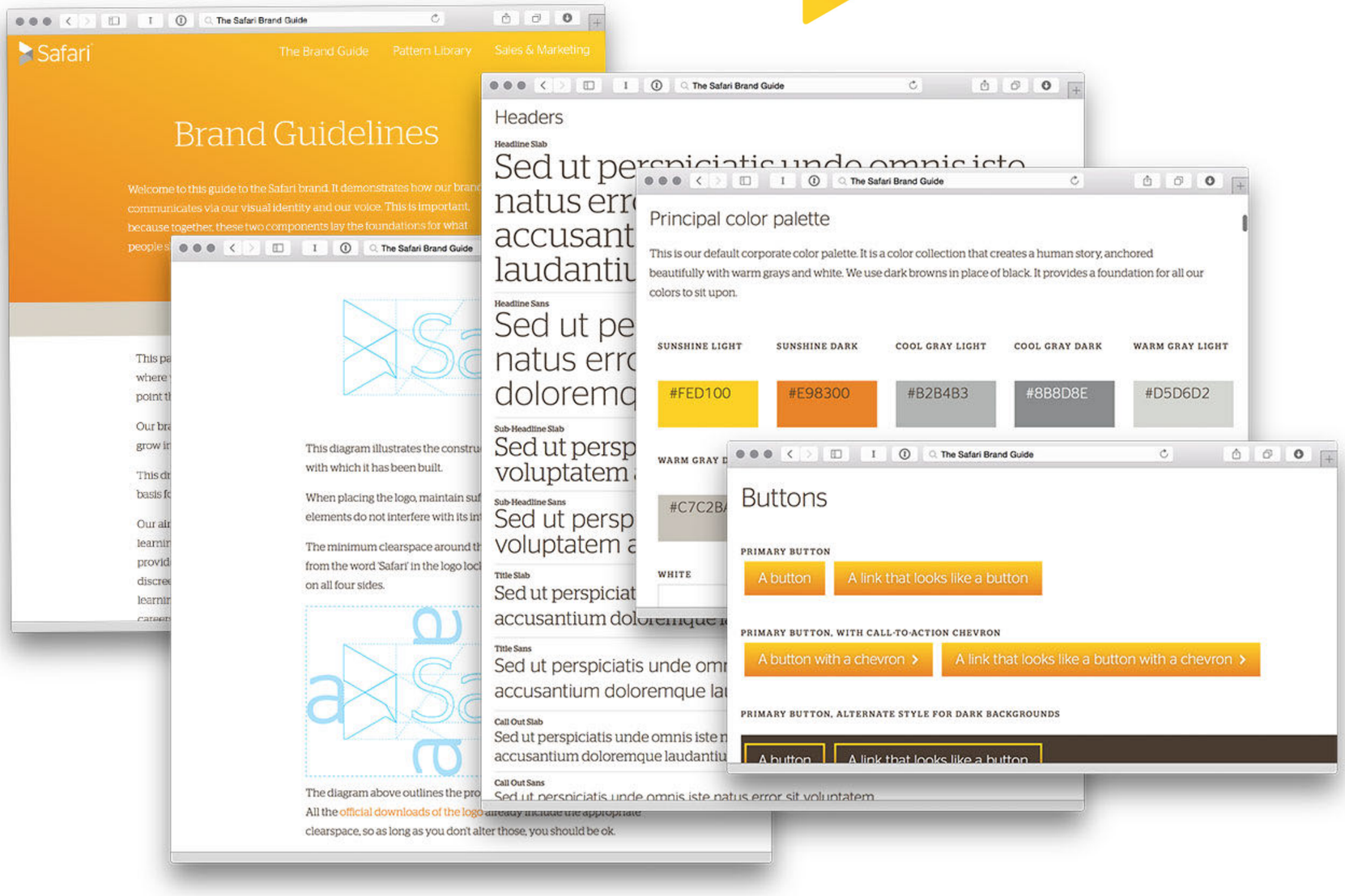
NYC, SF & BOSTON, 2014

ROLES IN THIS PROJECT:
Product design
User research
Interface design
Interaction design
Art direction
Front end development
Design management

After successfully bringing the Safari Flow service to market as a beta product, and proving that it was a service that we could grow into Safari Books Online's flagship offering, it was time to level up. Along with the transition from the old Safari Books Online to the new Safari Flow — now renamed to just 'Safari' — we decided that it was the right time to rethink the overall Safari brand.

Working with a branding consultant and an external graphic design studio, we went about articulating the company values and the brand promise, developing a new visual identity, and designing, developing, and launching a new corporate site.

Using the deliverables from our design studio as a starting point, we developed an internal style guide and pattern library. We used these resources to help us introduce the new brand across the company.



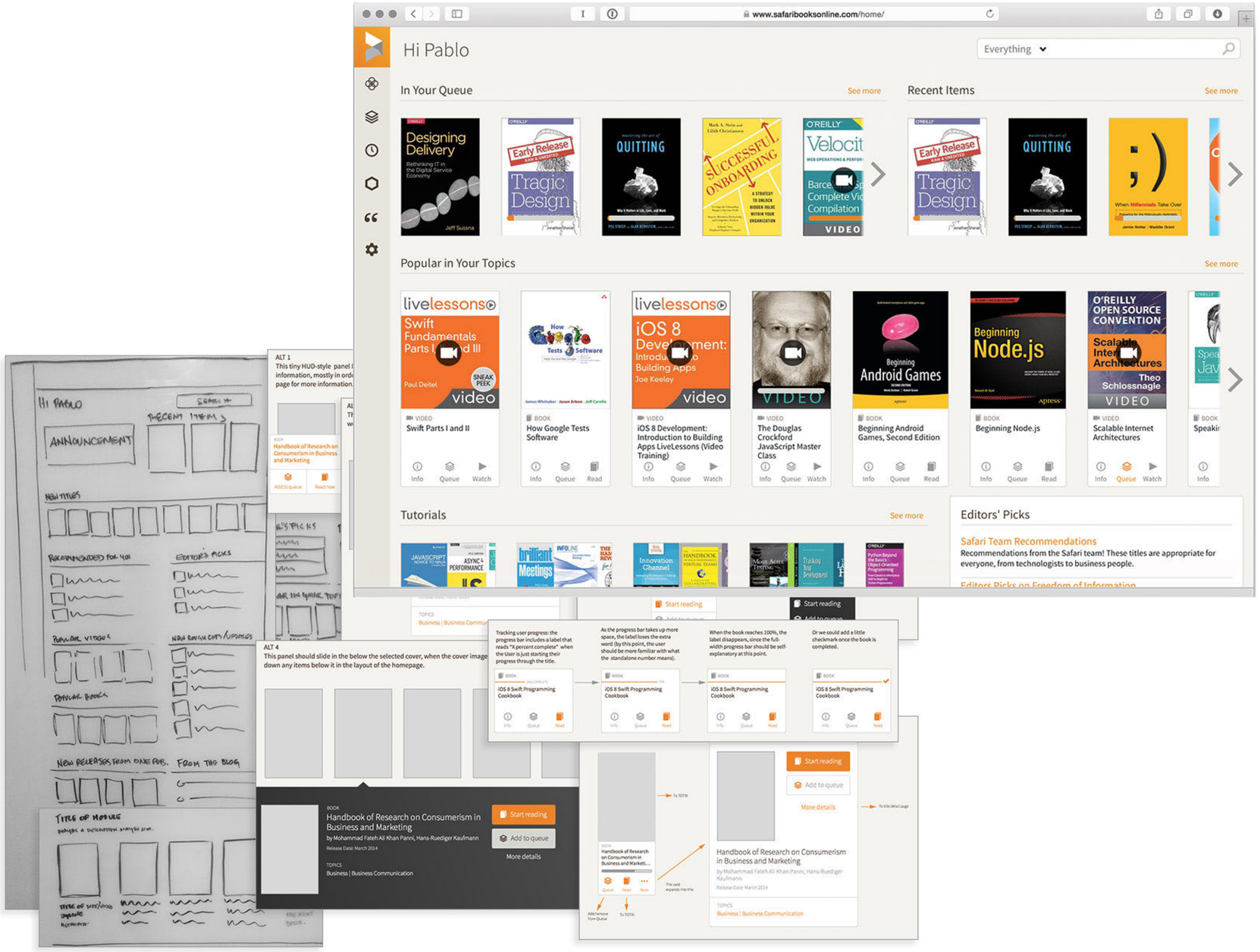
Safari Rebrand and Product Growth

NYC, SF & BOSTON, 2014

After the launch, we focused on expanding the feature set on the new Safari flagship product in order to make it more appealing to enterprise users. We also went about refining existing features through user research, testing, and optimization.

One of the parts of the new Safari product that we rethought after we transitioned from Safari Flow to new Safari was the main dashboard. Based on user feedback we'd been receiving over the course of several months, we determined that in order to better communicate Safari's full offering to the user, the dashboard needed to be much more information-dense than we'd originally passed for it to be.

We designed a smaller, tighter, more contained version of the cards we'd been using before, and put the work through some iterations based on rounds of a/b testing on a small subset of live users. The final product increased users' engagement with our books and videos, and provided a path forward for future optimization.



Safari Queue for Android & iOS

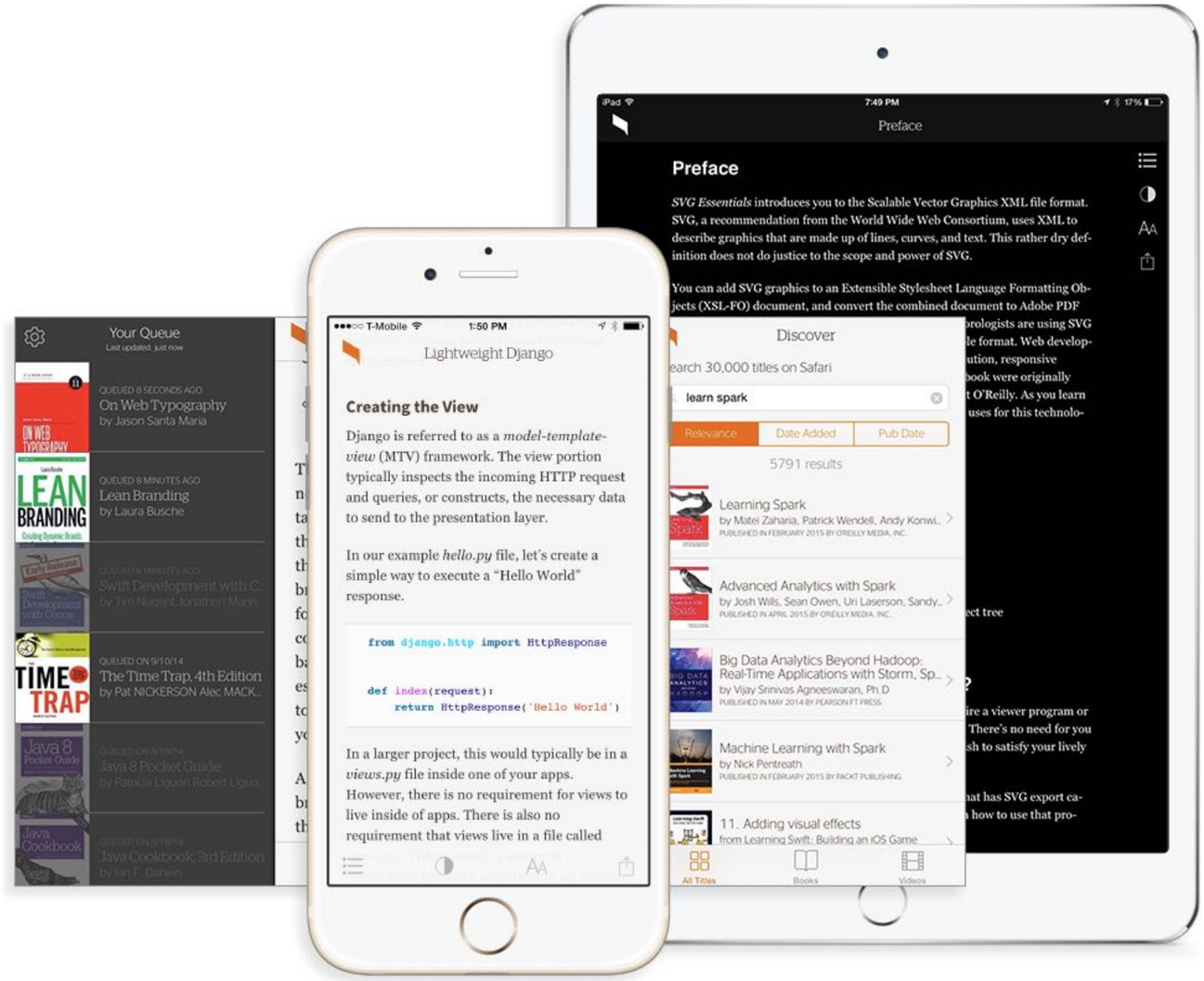
NYC, SF & BOSTON, 2015

We ultimately decided to focus on one particular feature of the new Safari service: the user's queue. On the new Safari web app, the queue is the place where a user saves items that they want to read later. This seemed like a good feature from which to work outward. We could build toward feature parity with the web app after we launched the 1.0.

Like the web app, the Queue app provides a beautiful, distraction-free reading interface. The reading interface includes the same functionality found on the web, as well as improvements that we identified and developed as we designed the first version of the app.

In the months after the initial 1.0 launch, we supplemented the core queuing and reading functionality with the ability to search the entire Safari library, as well as discover newly added books and videos.

Once we launched the 1.0 of the iOS app, we turned our attention to Safari Queue for Android. We established a core goal of feature parity with the iOS app, but we applied some of the lessons we learned while designing the iOS app. We also decided to follow Google's Material Design guidelines very closely when designing what Safari Queue would look like on Android



BRAND IDENTITY SAMPLER

Work by Pablo Defendini

SUBERIC NETWORKS

Suberic: A consulting firm specializing in IT infrastructure

Prepared for Edward Betancourt 26 January 2023

BRAND IDENTITY SAMPLER

Work by Pablo Defendini

Fireside
FICTION COMPANY

Fireside: A publishing company

Prepared for Edward Betancourt 26 January 2023

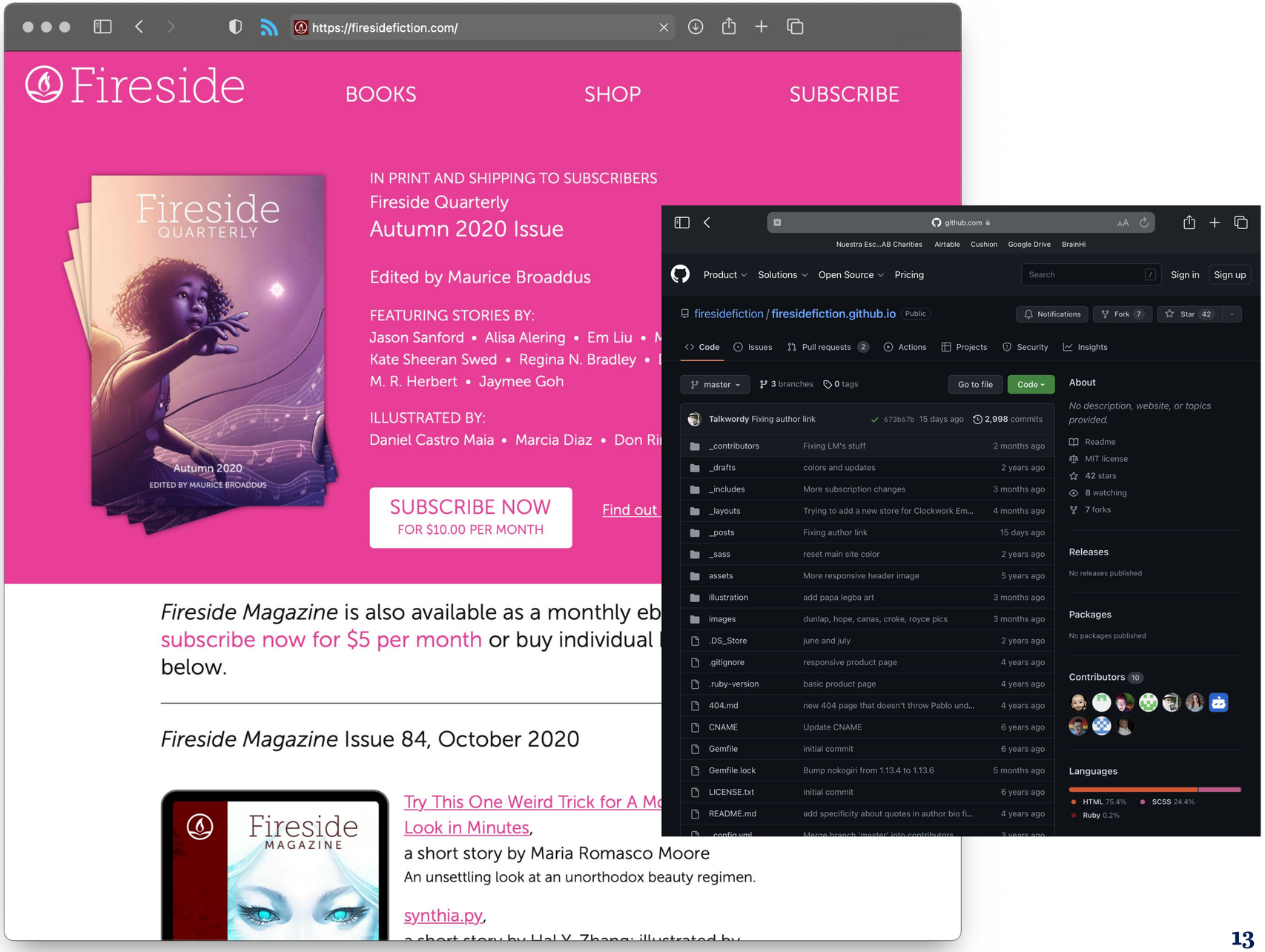
Fireside Magazine

NYC & BOSTON, 2017

ROLES IN THIS PROJECT:
Identity design
Interface design
Editorial design
Art direction
Editorial workflow design and implementation
Front end development
Customer service
Community management

After some years I took over Fireside as publisher and art director, and implemented a redesign of the online magazine site. The visual design is meant to be minimal and simple—it focuses the reader's attention entirely on the stories and original artwork, and provides a clean, simple, and responsive reading interface.

I also redesigned the magazine's workflow and tech stack using Hugo, a static site generator, and Github Pages as the host. I designed an editorial workflow in which editors work on markdown-formatted text files and push commits to a github repository, which in turn kicks off deployment onto the live site.



Fireside Quarterly

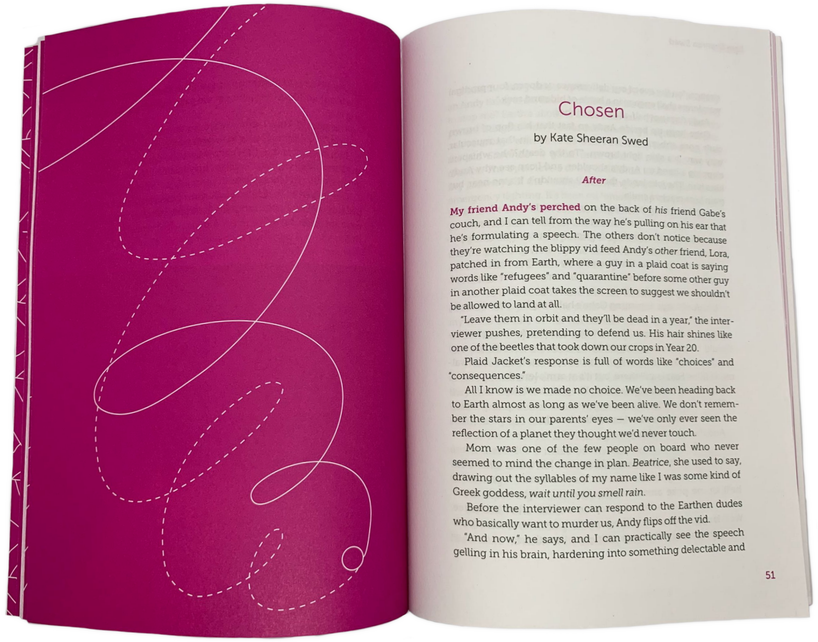
NYC & BOSTON, 2018

ROLES IN THIS PROJECT:
Identity design
Interface design
Editorial design
Art direction
Editorial workflow design and implementation
Print production
Shipping and logistics management
Community management
Customer service

Reworking the editorial workflow using software development tools and techniques allowed me to publish into a broader set of channels, and in 2018 I started publishing Fireside Quarterly, a premium print product containing all of the material destined to be published online.

Fireside Quarterly features two-color printing throughout, three triple-foldout full color illustrations, and bespoke art direction for each issue—both in print and when the material makes it onto the website.

Working with a single source in a software repository allowed me to adapt the stories and illustrations to take advantage of the unique properties of each medium. This led to many delightful — and award-winning — one-off, highly art-directed implementations of editorial content.



Chosen

by Kate Sheeran Swed

After

My friend Andy's perched on the back of *his* friend Gabe's couch, and I can tell from the way he's pulling on his ear that he's formulating a speech. The others don't notice because they're watching the blippy vid feed Andy's *other* friend, Lora, patched in from Earth, where a guy in a plaid coat is saying words like "refugees" and "quarantine" before some other guy in another plaid coat takes the screen to suggest we shouldn't be allowed to land at all.

"Leave them in orbit and they'll be dead in a year," the interviewer pushes, pretending to defend us. His hair shines like one of the beetles that took down our crops in Year 20.

Plaid Jacket's response is full of words like "choices" and "consequences."

All I know is we made no choice. We've been heading back to Earth almost as long as we've been alive. We don't remember the stars in our parents' eyes — we've only ever seen the reflection of a planet they thought we'd never touch.

Mom was one of the few people on board who never seemed to mind the change in plan. *Beatrice*, she used to say, drawing out the syllables of my name like I was some kind of Greek goddess, *wait until you smell rain*.

Before the interviewer can respond to the Earthen dudes who basically want to murder us, Andy flips off the vid.

"And now," he says, and I can practically see the speech gelling in his brain, hardening into something delectable and

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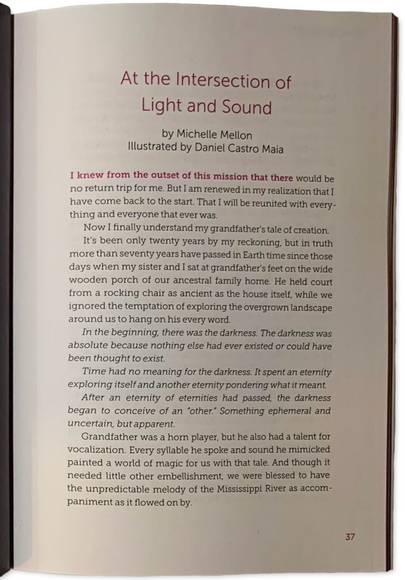

At the Intersection of
Light and Sound

by Michelle Mellon
Illustrated by Daniel Castro Maia

I knew from the outset of this mission that there would be no return trip for me. But I am renewed in my realization that I have come back to the start. That I will be reunited with everything and everyone that ever was.

Now I finally understand my grandfather's tale of creation.

It's been only twenty years by my reckoning, but in truth more than seventy years have passed in Earth time since those days when my sister and I sat at grandfather's feet on the wide wooden porch of our ancestral family home. He held court from a rocking chair as ancient as the house itself, while we ignored the temptation of exploring the overgrown landscape around us to hang on his every word.

In the beginning, there was the darkness. The darkness was absolute because nothing else had ever existed or could have been thought to exist.

Time had no meaning for the darkness. It spent an eternity exploring itself and another eternity pondering what it meant.

After an eternity of eternities had passed, the darkness began to conceive of an "other." Something ephemeral and uncertain, but apparent.

Grandfather was a horn player, but he also had a talent for vocalization. Every syllable he spoke and sound he mimicked painted a world of magic for us with that tale. And though it needed little other embellishment, we were blessed to have the unpredictable melody of the Mississippi River as accompaniment as it flowed on by.

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